

THE PARENT-COACH PLAYBOOK

The Practice Plan *Template.*

A printable practice plan parents can read.

One page a week. Four lines per session. Share with your parent email list 24 hours before practice. Stops the guessing. The single highest-leverage thing a youth coach can do.

EDITED BY THE PCP DESK

PRINT-FRIENDLY EDITION · FREE TO SHARE

01 / HOW TO USE THIS

Don't wing it. Don't hide it.

Ten minutes a week. Parents stop guessing.

The single highest-leverage thing a youth coach can do is share a written practice plan with the parents. Open the template. Fill in four lines per session. Share view-only with the parent email list twenty-four hours before practice.

It takes about ten minutes a week to do well. The parents who can see the plan stop guessing — about timing, about pickup, about whether their kid is supposed to bring shin guards or just water. The kids who walk into a practice their parents already half-understand show up calmer.

THE FOUR LINES, EVERY SESSION

- **Date / time / location.** Field number, gate, weather call.
- **Focus of the day.** One thing. Not three.
- **Drill list with timing.** 5 / 10 / 15 / 20 / 5. Total: sixty minutes.
- **Job for parents.** What you need from them. Or "nothing today."

"The character development happens in the drills, not in the bullet points. Keep the plan boring."

02 / BLANK TEMPLATE

Print this. Fill twice.

Two sessions per page covers most weeks. Print again for a game-week double-up.

SESSION 1

WHEN / WHERE	_____
FOCUS OF THE DAY	_____
DRILL LIST	5 min: 10 min: 15 min: 20 min: 5 min: huddle, snack, reminders
JOB FOR PARENTS	_____

SESSION 2

WHEN / WHERE	_____
FOCUS OF THE DAY	_____
DRILL LIST	5 min: 10 min: 15 min: 20 min: 5 min: huddle, snack, reminders
JOB FOR PARENTS	_____

Tip. Make a copy each week. Date the printout. Drop it in a binder. After one season you have a real archive of what worked and what didn't.

03 / TWO FILLED EXAMPLES

What it actually looks like.

One baseball, one soccer. Both 60 minutes. Both written the night before.

BASEBALL / U10 / WEEK 4 OF THE SEASON

WHEN / WHERE	Tuesday, April 16 · 5:30–6:30 PM · Field 3
FOCUS OF THE DAY	Cutoff throws and live BP rotation.
DRILL LIST	5 min: stretching + dynamic warm-up 10 min: throwing program (partners, 30 ft) 15 min: cutoff drill at second base (Coach Dan leads) 20 min: live BP rotation (3 hitters, 4 fielders, rotate every 4 swings) 5 min: huddle, snack, reminders for Saturday
JOB FOR PARENTS	If you can stay, parents on the third-base line for help during BP rotation are great. Two hands on a wiffle bat each.

SOCCER / U8 / WEEK 2 OF THE SEASON

WHEN / WHERE	Wednesday, Sept 11 · 5:00–6:00 PM · East Park, field 2
FOCUS OF THE DAY	Spacing. Stop the bunching.
DRILL LIST	5 min: sharks-and-minnows (warm body, light touch on the ball) 10 min: shoelace touches in a 10-yard square, partner work 15 min: four-corner passing, two balls at once 20 min: 4v4 scrimmage with two zones — kids must stay in their half 5 min: water, high-fives, reminders about Saturday's 9 AM start
JOB FOR PARENTS	Two parents on the touchline as soft cone walls during 4v4. Helps the kids keep shape without us yelling "spread out!"

Notice what's not in either one. A long philosophical preamble. A list of life lessons. A reference to character development. The plan is what we're doing for sixty minutes. The character development happens in the drills, not in the bullet points.

04 / STARTER DRILLS BY AGE

Steal what fits. Ignore what doesn't.

Where to start each band. The list is generative, not prescriptive.

AGE	WARM-UP	SKILL BLOCK	GAME ELEMENT
5–7	Animal walks (3 min). Body parts game.	Throwing partners (5 min, soft balls).	Run-the-bases relay. Sharks and minnows.
8–10	Dynamic stretching circuit (4–5 min).	Throwing program. Two-cone passing.	Live BP rotation (3 hitters). Small-sided 4v4.
11–12	Dynamic + agility ladder (5–7 min).	Cutoff and relay drill. Rondo passing.	Situational scrimmage (1 inning / quarter).
13+	Full warmup, longer arc, body-prep work.	Position-specific work. Match-tempo reps.	Live game scenarios (2 innings / halves).

If you only remember one thing from this page: kids under ten don't need a fourth drill. They need the first three to last longer. Kids over twelve don't need fewer drills. They need scrimmage minutes that look like a real game.

For deeper drill libraries by sport and age — a few hundred of them, free — visit parentcoachplaybook.com/coaching-tips.

KEEP READING

More tools. Every week.

If this template helped, the publication has more.

WHAT'S NEXT IN THE ARCHIVE

What to Say When — our 28-page field guide of twenty-three scripts for the moments before and after the game, and the hard ones in between. Free.

The Pre-Game Pocket Card — laminate-able, glove-box-sized. One panel per drive.

Drills by sport and age — a few hundred of them, free, at parentcoachplaybook.com/coaching-tips.

Reads — short pieces on tryouts, travel teams, the parent on the team you can't stand, the cost of a season, what to say when your kid wants to quit.

HOW TO GET THE NEXT ONE

Visit **parentcoachplaybook.com**. Subscribe to the newsletter. New issues every week. Back catalog free.

PRINT THIS. SHARE IT.

This template is free. Print it for an assistant coach, a co-parent, the team mom organizing your snack rotation. The more parents who see the plan, the easier the season runs.

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